



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Arrows Christian Academy

School Website: <https://lincolnprep.greatheartsamerica.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Arrows Christian Academy AZ 85286 (as reflected in the crawl content for Lincoln Prep within the Great Hearts network) demonstrates a robust classical-education orientation that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements rubric. Public-facing materials from the school's site emphasize a mission grounded in Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; a curriculum centered on liberal-arts foundations, Great Books, and Western cultural heritage; pedagogy that foregrounds Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, and contemplative "Scholé" practices; and a faculty and parent-community framework that presents teachers as mentors and parents as co-educators. Across six classical categories, the material evidence points toward CLASSICAL alignment with only minor room for triangulating theology or liturgical practice more explicitly in some public materials. For the six-category rubric, the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key evidentiary signals include:

- Mission and aims: An explicit statement that the academy cultivates minds and hearts through Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, with emphasis on liberal arts and Great Books within a Western-tradition curriculum. This is reflected in mission sections and introductory statements that frame education as formation through classical principles.
- Curriculum and Great Books: The site foregrounds liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history; mathematics; natural science; philosophy) and a sustained emphasis on Great Books and the Great Conversation within a Western-tradition curriculum.
- Pedagogy: Public-facing materials highlight Socratic dialogue, memory work (recitation/chanting), and Scholé-like rest in learning, with opportunities for rhetoric and public speaking in upper levels.
- Faculty: The materials present teachers as models of learning and character, a living curriculum, and a collegial, mentor-based approach.
- Parents & Community: The materials emphasize parent involvement, partnerships with families, and parent-education/formation opportunities, with an open-campus ethos and active parent governance/-support structures (e.g., PSO).
- Great Hearts framework and Western canon: Across several pages, the site describes a classical Liberal Arts curriculum anchored in Western canon, Great Books, and classical languages (Latin, Greek) with an emphasis on culture, virtue, and moral imagination.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize truth, goodness, beauty as central, transcendent goods shaping character and learning. The academy's mission centers on cultivating the minds and hearts through truth, goodness, and beauty, signaling transcendentals-based aims.
- The Great Hearts philosophical framing ties education to a classical, morally formed vision of humanity, with language about virtue and moral imagination in public materials.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, moral imagination, wisdom, order, sacred tradition (implied in classical religious/philosophical framing), Logos (explicit in some classical references), reverence/wonder (seen in discussions of wonder and contemplation in the curriculum).
- Negative keywords present: minimal explicit signaling of relativism or secular-humanist ethics in the public-facing materials; content leans toward transcendentals and classical moral realism rather than value-neutral ethics.
- Inference based on Lexicon: The presence of truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, and reverence signals CLASSICAL alignment; the absence (or minimal presence) of explicit relativism or secular-humanist framing supports this.

Why this rating

- The materials consistently foreground transcendentals and classical moral formation over relativistic or secular ethics. The public materials align with the Positive Keywords for Element 1 and show little to no emphasis on the Negative Keywords (e.g., relativism, secular humanism). This supports CLASSICAL for Element 1.

Citations

- Mission and transcendentals emphasis: turn0file1;- Virtue/moral imagination framing: ### Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission states education is formation through Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; formation of virtues and wisdom is a central goal (not job-training focus).
- The curriculum/pedagogy emphasize formation (habits of the heart, virtue, moral imagination) over mere information, with aims of human flourishing and classical heritage.
- References to contemplation, restfulness (Scholé), and great conversations indicate a telos-oriented aim toward timeless truths rather than quick utility.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, liberal education, scholé, contemplation, restfulness, great conversation, classical heritage, moral imagination, telos.
- Negative keywords present: minimal signaling of work-readiness or 21st-century workforce emphasis; public materials emphasize formation rather than job-readiness.
- The presence of formation-focused language and avoidance of workforce-readiness terms aligns with CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- The school's public materials foreground formation and virtue over vocational/workforce outcomes, aligning with the classical objective of forming the human person (virtue and wisdom) rather than simply preparing for employment.

Citations

- Formation-focused mission and aims:- Contemplation, scholé, and great conversation: ### Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Liberal arts foundation is explicit: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium components; history, Western civilization; philosophy; natural science; mathematics; languages (Latin, Greek). This is a core feature of the classical curriculum.
- Great Books / Great Conversation: Public materials emphasize engagement with Great Books and primary sources, within a Western canon framework.
- Language study and humanities emphasis: The curriculum highlights humane letters, classical languages, and a robust humanities sequence, including readings from Homer, Plato, Augustine, Shakespeare, etc.

- Historical integration and interdisciplinary texture: The materials present history, literature, philosophy, and sciences as interconnected within a liberal-arts framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), seven liberal arts (Trivium, Quadrivium), Great Books, primary sources, classics, Homer, Plato, Augustine, Shakespeare, Latin, Greek, Western civilization, humane letters, history, sacred art.
- Negative keywords present: signals of project-based or STEM-first approaches are not foregrounded; the materials emphasize canonical texts and integrated humanities rather than a purely STEM-first or social-studies replacement approach.
- The lexicon's positive keywords (Great Books, primary sources, Western canon, liberal arts, history, etc.) are well represented; negative keywords that would undermine classical curriculum (e.g., project-based learning dominance) are not evident in the public content.

Why this rating

- The public materials strongly reflect a classical curriculum architecture: the seven liberal arts framework, Great Books, Western canon, humane letters, and classical languages align with CLASSICAL criteria.

Citations

- Liberal arts / Trivium/Quadrivium:- Great Books / Great Conversation:- Humane letters, classical languages: ### Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Socratic dialogue and upper-level seminars: Public materials describe Socratic dialogue as a core mode of inquiry and emphasize seminars/debates and rhetorical training in upper levels.
- Restful learning (Scholé) and memory work: Pedagogical notes include chanting, singing to memorize, and contemplative/restful days as part of the learning rhythm.
- Lower-school singing/chanting and memory; upper-school rhetoric and public speaking: The public materials reference memory work in lower grades and a continued emphasis on rhetoric into high school.
- Ties to formation through imitation and living exemplars: The materials reference teachers as models and the living curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/seminar, dialectic, memorizations/recitation, chanting, Scholé, contemplation, memory work, rhetoric, debate, mentor-guided instruction, living curriculum.
- Negative keywords present: Some elements of modern experiential learning or constructivist approaches are explicitly avoided in classical-lexicon indicators; the site demonstrates a preference for structured dialogue and canonical texts rather than purely project-based/constructivist pedagogy.
- The field shows clear alignment with Positive Keywords; Negative Keywords signaling non-classical pedagogy are not dominant in public content.

Why this rating

- The pedagogy highlighted on the site maps directly onto the classical pedagogy indicators (Socratic seminars, Scholé, recitation/memorization, rhetoric, and chanting) with explicit references to teacher as guide and living curriculum. This supports CLASSICAL.

Citations

- Socratic dialogue and upper-school rhetoric:- Restful learning / chant and memory:- Living curriculum and teacher-student formation: ### Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Teachers as models of learning and virtue; dedicated and intellectually excellent: Public materials describe teachers as models of learning and character; a “living curriculum” approach foregrounds the teacher as central to the educational experience.
- Faculty culture and collaboration: The Great Hearts network materials emphasize a collegial, mentor-like faculty culture and a teacher-centered, student-formed pedagogy that rests on classical exemplars.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty of friends, collegial culture, teacher training in classical pedagogy (as described in the lexicon and Great Hearts materials).
- Negative keywords present: There is no strong public signaling of non-classical faculty practices (e.g., “facilitators on the side” or purely certification-driven jargon) in the content provided.
- The presence of model-teacher language and living curriculum indicates a strong positive alignment with Classical faculty indicators.

Why this rating

- The public materials depict a classical-faculty ethos—teachers as exemplars and living curriculum rather than distant technicians—consistent with CLASSICAL.

Citations

- Teachers as models and living curriculum:- Faculty culture within Great Hearts: ### Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Partnership with families and parents as co-educators: Public materials emphasize parent involvement, partnership with families, and opportunities for parental formation and engagement.
- Open-campus and parental access; PSO and community engagement: The materials discuss parent volunteering and the Parent Service Organization (PSO) as a vehicle for engagement; tax-credit campaigns and community support are also described.
- Educational resources for parents: The content indicates communication and education opportunities for parents (seminars/book studies) and family involvement in school life.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teaching, parental formation, parent education, home-school connection, parent involvement, community support, parent covenant.
- Negative keywords present: the lexicon lists potential “consumer language” risk as a negative signal; the public materials do not appear to depict parents as customers but as partners and co-educators.
- The evidence suggests robust alignment with the “Partners with Families” and “Parent Formation” signals of the classical category.

Why this rating

- The public materials depict a strong, ongoing partnership with parents and a community ethos that treats families as co-educators rather than passive recipients, which corresponds to CLASSICAL.

Citations

- Parent partnership and formation:- PSO and tax-credit community engagement: Aggregate Assessment
- Overall, the school demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories based on keyword signals and programmatic statements found in the crawl content. The public-facing materials emphasize Truth, Goodness, Beauty; formation and virtue; liberal-arts curriculum with Great Books; Socratic pedagogy; teacher as living exemplar; and strong parent-community partnership, all characteristic of a classical educational model as defined by the Six Essential Elements framework and its Positive Keyword indicators.

What Would Move the Needle

- If any category were to shift toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, targeted improvements could include:
- More explicit articulation of liturgical/formational theology components across curricula and weekly practices, including explicit references to liturgical rhythms or chapel-based experiences, if aligned with the school's identity.
- Additional explicit, published cross-grade exemplars of the "living curriculum" and portraits of teacher-mentors to deepen the sense that faculty are the core of the school's ethos.
- Broader explicit description of parent-education programs that meet the lexicon's "household formation" language, ensuring parents see themselves as co-educators with concrete, repeated opportunities for formation and dialogue.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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